

comparisons when we were purchasing our tickets, and found that they matched or beat any deal I found anywhere else, including with the airline itself. Puerto Vallarta, anyone?

55. [BookIt.com](#)

If we had purchased the fabulous “honeymoon in a package,” we would have purchased it here. Again, I did the price comparisons, and they’re the best. And no, I don’t have any idea why they aren’t more popular.

— Sarah Winfrey

How to Throw a Fun, Inexpensive Kid’s Birthday Party



The most fun, memorable and inexpensive birthday party for your child may be, figuratively and literally, right in your own backyard. I’ve attended and hosted fabulous but simple parties with cake, ice cream, and a few balloons, and participated in much bigger backyard extravaganzas. But, just because a party is at home doesn’t mean that it will be cheap and easy to orchestrate. I’ll share a few tips for throwing a happy event that’s light on cash outlay and effort.

Be aware of but not intimidated by the fervor around children’s birthday parties. On one occasion years back, I picked up a parenting magazine for families in my area. In this 46-page publication, there are 15 ads from birthday party purveyors, ranging from magicians to nearly complete packages at a butterfly farm, party palace, and an art studio. Prices start at about \$300 for eight children.

My kids have attended parties that involved:

- Dinner at a nice restaurant
- Mad Science presentation
- Backyard carnival with cotton candy fishing booth, and more
- Backyard petting zoo and pony rides
- Activities led by Taekwondo instructors at a martial arts studio